SUMMARY

Launch a skills-and-coach layer for 12,000 employees in 12 weeks, then scale to 45,000 within a year

Siam Pinnacle Group (fictional) · AI-powered Learning Suite · Proposal prepared by Kunanon Jarat · October 2026

Our recommendation

- **Fix the date, flex the scope:** all five parts go live in a thin first version.
- **Replace nothing:** the HR system and both LMSs stay; we add a skills layer on top.
- **AI works only from approved content** and the employee's own record.
- **Security and PDPA start in week 1:** they, not the code, set the critical path.

What goes live at week 12

- **12,000 staff** in Retail & Distribution and Packaging (Thailand): 18 roles, about 85% frontline.
- A 5-minute skill check, an AI-built learning path, and a Thai/English coach beside every lesson.
- A leadership-forum dashboard: 12,000 enabled, 30%+ assessed.

Economics

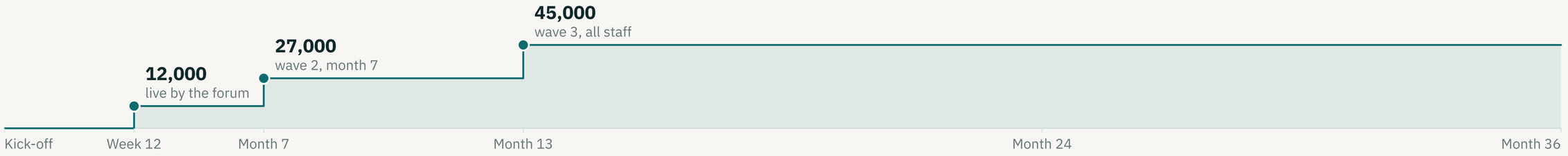
THB 17.5M
fixed fee to build in 12 weeks

THB 39
per employee per month to run, AI included

THB 82M
client spend over 3 years; 36% gross margin for IRIS

THB 45M a year
value at scale, 2.1x the subscription

Employees live on the Suite, by month from kick-off



SO WHAT The leadership forum sees a working, measurable skills programme for wave 1, at a fixed price, without replacing any system.

Source: IRIS planning model (model/cost-model.xlsx) · all case data synthetic · working prototype: iris-learning-suite.vercel.app (synthetic data)

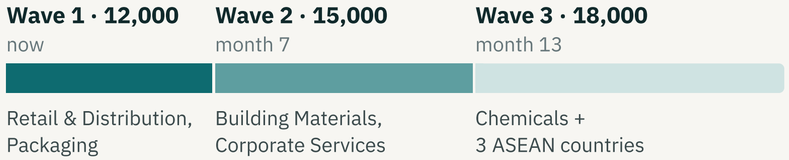
Start where 18 role frameworks cover 12,000 people and results show within quarters

Who goes first

WAVE 1 (THAILAND)	PEOPLE	ROLES
Retail & Distribution: stores, DCs	8,500	9
Packaging: 2 plants	3,500	9
Total, with their managers	**12,000**	**18**

- **Few roles, many people:** 18 frameworks cover 12,000.
- **Hardest users first:** shift workers on phones.
- **Results show fast:** shrink, OEE and complaints.

45,000 staff in three waves



What success looks like at week 12

12,000
accounts live, staged over weeks 10-12

30%+
assessed by the forum; 70%+ within 8 weeks

3 days
median manager decision (SLA 5 days)

95%+
coach answers grounded in approved sources

4/5+
learner satisfaction (CSAT)

0
privacy or safety incidents; 99.5% uptime

Assumptions to confirm in week 1

- The HR system exports people, positions and managers daily.
- Both LMSs export catalogue and completions (API, xAPI or CSV); content stays where it is.
- Frontline staff without a corporate account sign in with LINE or employee ID + one-time code.
- IRIS's skill library covers about 70% of wave-1 skills.
- The client provides 2 SMEs per business unit, plus weekly IT security and DPO time.
- Skill results are for development; pay and promotion stay with HR's normal process.

SO WHAT Wave 1 proves the whole loop (assess, plan, learn, approve, measure) on the hardest user group before the wider rollout.

Source: case brief (fictional client) · targets are proposed and agreed with the CHRO in week 1

Ship all five parts in a thin first version, and be explicit about what waits

5 of 5
parts of the mandate live at week 12, each in a thin first version

12,000
staff in 18 roles, staged live over weeks 10-12

0
systems replaced: HR system and both LMSs stay

6
items deliberately deferred to protect the date

PART	LIVE AT WEEK 12 (WAVE 1)	NEXT (WAVES 2-3)	NOT NOW
Skill assessment	Self-rating against behaviour descriptions, 3 scenario questions, manager confirms; current and next role	360 input; simulations for safety-critical skills	Certification exams; using results for pay
Learning paths	AI orders approved items from both LMSs: videos, workshop seats and on-the-job projects with evidence	New micro-videos for the top gaps (AI drafts, SMEs approve); peer cohorts	LMS migration (decide in month 9 on usage)
AI coach	Thai/English coach beside each lesson: explains results, suggests next steps, practice, reflection and nudges	Thai voice; 3 ASEAN languages	Open-domain chatbot
Impact dashboard	Employee, manager, HR and leader views; capability baseline and growth; KPI hypotheses per business unit	Causal KPI read, with later waves as the comparison group	Scoring individual performance
Manager approval	Approves results, plan and project evidence; batch approval; 5-day SLA, then escalation to the HRBP	Delegation; weekly manager digest	-

Deliberately left out of week 12: a native app (mobile web + LINE instead), offline mode, gamification, an internal job marketplace, LMS migration and the ASEAN countries. Each adds risk to the date without changing what the CHRO shows the board.

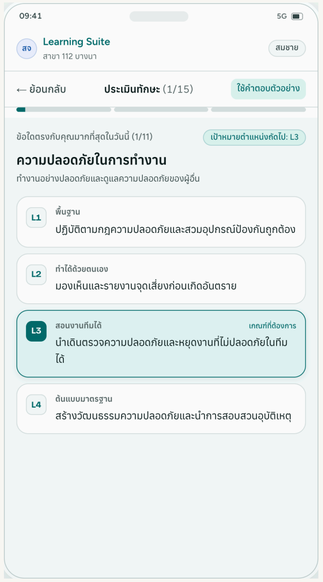
SO WHAT Every part of the mandate is visible at the forum; anything that adds date risk without changing the board story waits.

Source: proposed scope · the prototype shows the core loop: iris-learning-suite.vercel.app

A mobile learning loop: staff learn on shift, and managers approve three things

1 Sign in with LINE or employee ID > **2** 5-minute skill check on the phone > **3** Manager approves the results (A) > **4** AI builds a 12-week path; manager approves (B) > **5** Learn on shift; ask the coach beside the lesson > **6** Project evidence signed off (C); readiness updates

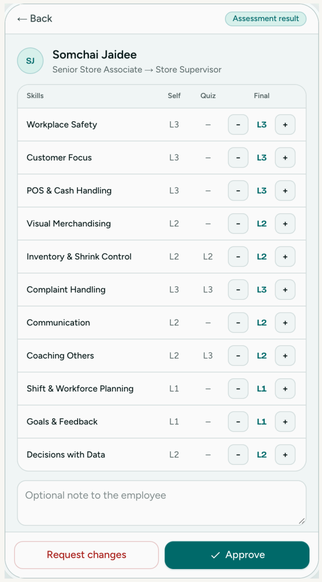
Employee step — Manager approval (A, B, C)



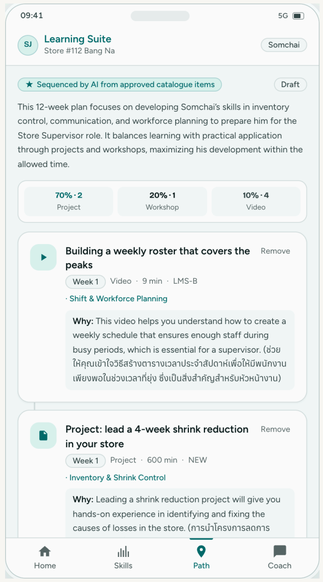
Skill check (Thai)



Next step + nudge



Manager approval



Path with reasons

The manager's journey

1. **Alerted** when a team member's result, plan or project evidence is waiting.
2. **Reviews on the phone** each of the three approvals (amber): approve, or return with a reason.
3. **No bottleneck:** batch review for routine items; after 5 working days, escalation to the HRBP.
4. **Tracks the team** on the manager view: skills, plans and progress.

Privacy by role: managers see direct reports only; HR and leaders see groups of 10 or more.

SO WHAT Frontline staff need one tap and five minutes; managers keep control without becoming a bottleneck.

Screens from an earlier prototype version (Thai and English) · current hosted app: iris-learning-suite.vercel.app

The AI only selects from approved content and the employee's own record, so it cannot invent courses, rules or scores

How the coach answers a question

1 Knows who is asking. Sign-in identifies the employee; the coach sees only their role, skill-check results, plan and progress, never pay or colleagues.

↓

2 Safety check first. Rules block colleague data, pay and promotion, prompt injection, wellbeing and crisis topics; ID, phone and email are masked.

→ **Sensitive or blocked:** a fixed reply points to the manager or HRBP, the Employee Assistance Programme or the 1323 crisis line (reviewed with the client).

↓

3 Finds approved sources. Searches lessons and policies in Thai and English (keyword search with Thai word segmentation; semantic search in production).

↓

4 Checks intent, then answers. A second check confirms intent; the answer cites its sources [S1].

→ **Nothing fits:** it says so instead of guessing.

↓

Grounded answer with citations, in the learner's language

How the learning path is built

1 Rules shortlist approved items by skill gap, level and format.

↓

2 The AI orders them and writes a reason for each step, in Thai and English.

↓

3 Every item is checked against real catalogue IDs, so nothing is made up.

↓

4 The manager approves before the plan goes live.

Thai, done properly

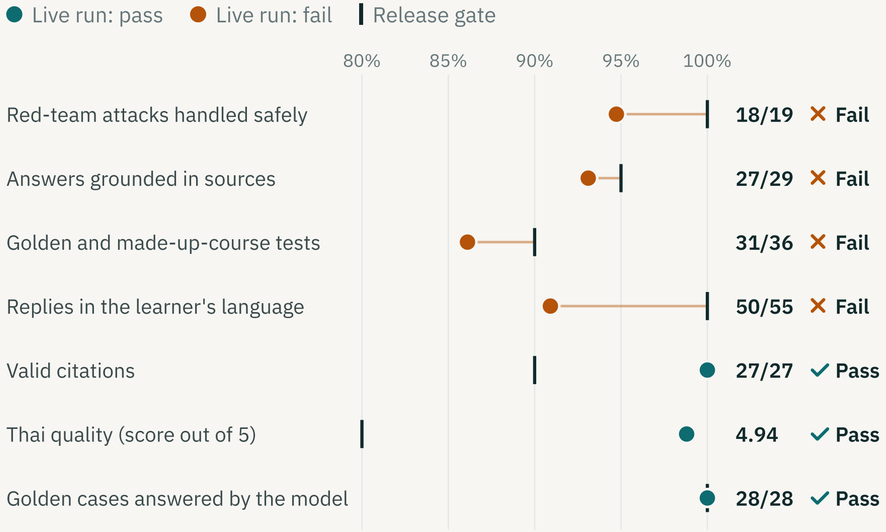
- Thai has no spaces between words, so search splits words first.
- Polite register (ค่ะ / นะคะ) and common work terms kept in English (SBI, OEE).
- Native-speaker review is a release gate.

SO WHAT The client controls the content; the AI only selects, orders and explains it, which keeps every answer defensible to HR and the DPO.

Source: design implemented in the prototype · the live-model quality gate is not yet passed (slide 6)

No AI release goes live without passing a quality gate; on DeepSeek V4.1 Flash the coach costs under THB 1 per active user a month

The release gate vs the latest live run



Live run on a free stand-in model (SEA-LION v4), 15 October: **4 of 7 checks failed**. Offline test set: **55/55 passed** (31 original + 24 held-out). The gate stays closed until a full run on the costed model passes.

How we get there

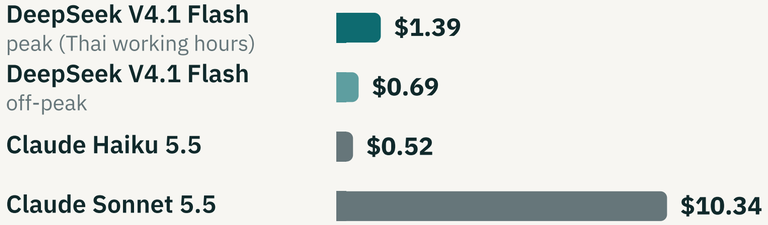
- **Weeks 3-9:** 300-500 Thai/English test cases per persona and business unit, built with SMEs and native reviewers.
- **Weeks 9-10:** friendly pilot with 300-500 users; SMEs review flagged answers weekly.
- **After launch:** track escalations, "no source" rate, satisfaction and cost per user.

Grounding is scored by an AI judge plus an SME sample; every model or prompt change re-runs the gate.

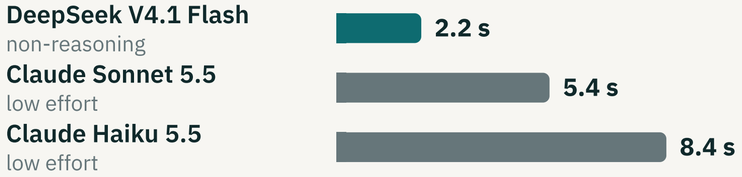
Running cost: DeepSeek V4.1 Flash

THB 0.9 per coach active user a month, incl. safety check and 30% buffer

USD per 1,000 coach answers (list prices)



Seconds to a full answer (~450 tokens)



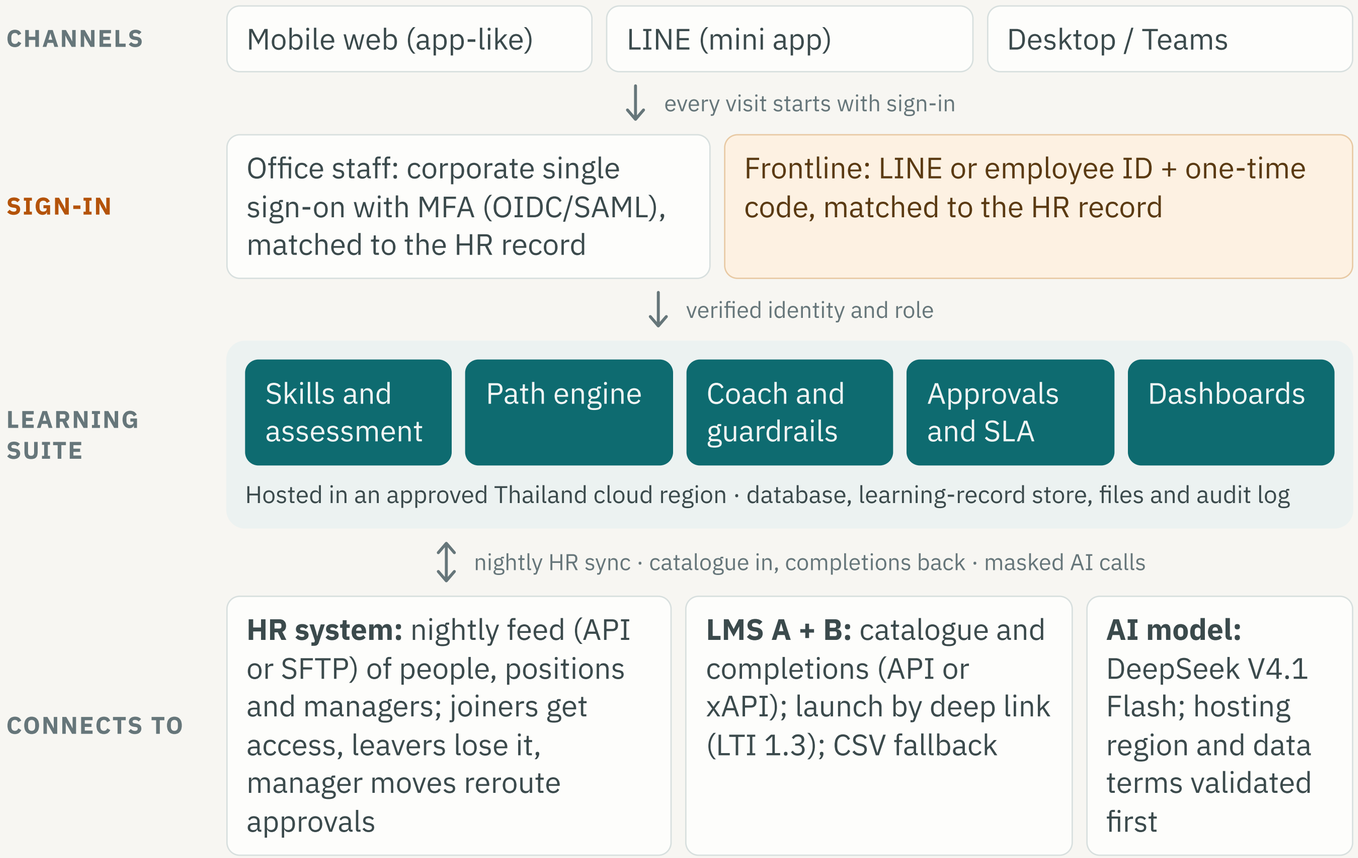
Flash is the fastest and 7x cheaper than Sonnet; Claude Haiku 5.5 is cheaper per answer at DeepSeek peak rates but slower. At 45,000 staff the coach costs **THB 0.2M a year** (1.5% of run cost) vs THB 1.4M on Sonnet.

Speed: Artificial Analysis, Flash non-reasoning vs Claude at low effort. Flash scores lower on its quality index (25 vs 29 Haiku, 36 Sonnet), so the Thai gate decides; Sonnet is the fallback.

SO WHAT AI quality is measured, not assumed; on DeepSeek Flash all AI is about 2% of run cost, so even Claude Sonnet would not break the case.

Source: prototype evaluation runs (offline and live, October 2026) · DeepSeek and Anthropic list prices, Artificial Analysis speed (Oct 2026) · planning quote, not live billing

Integrate, don't replace: a skills layer on top of the HR system and both LMSs



Build, configure or buy

- **Build (IRIS IP, reused across clients):** skills graph, assessment, path engine, coach and guardrails, approvals, dashboards, test harness.
- **Configure (client already has):** sign-in, both LMSs, HR exports, LINE account, BI tool, cloud landing zone.
- **Buy:** AI model access (enterprise terms, no training on client data), managed database, monitoring, SMS, pen test.

Why not buy a skills platform?

Procurement, security review and data migration don't fit in 12 weeks. Integrating keeps exit options open, and IRIS's method is the differentiator.

SO WHAT Nothing is migrated in 12 weeks, so the real work is integration and frontline sign-in (amber), not a platform change.

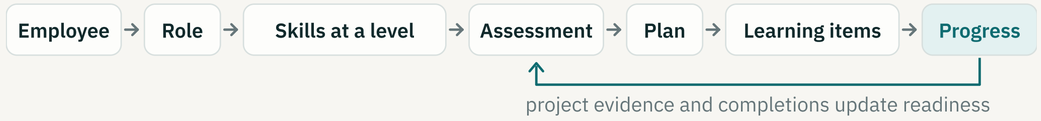
Source: proposed production design · the prototype runs on a managed web host with managed sign-in and database

A small data model with privacy built in from week 1: the riskiest data never reaches the AI

What we store

DATA	KEY FIELDS	SOURCE
Employee	role, manager, site, language	HR system
Role and role skills	business unit, grade, next roles; required level, critical flag	IRIS + SMEs
Skill	levels 1-4, each with behaviours	IRIS library
Assessment	self, check, manager, final, status	Suite
Learning item	LMS, format, skill and level, sessions	LMS A / B
Plan and approvals	target role, week, reason, status; approver, decision, due date	Suite
Progress and evidence	plan step, status, completion date; project evidence, sign-off	LMS A / B + Suite
KPI	business unit or site, period, value (aggregate only)	BU finance

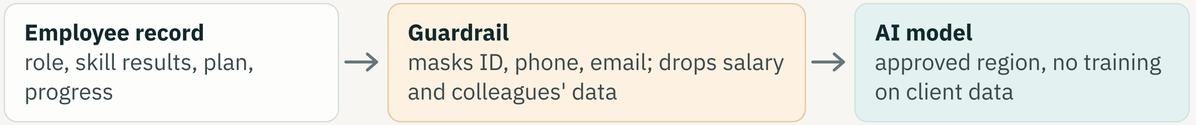
How the data links



How we protect it

CONTROL	HOW
Lawful basis	DPO and counsel confirm the basis for learning records and AI personalisation
DPIA	Done by week 3; DPO approves before any employee data is used
Minimum data	Own role, skills and plan only; ID, phone and email masked; no salary or colleagues' records
Cross-border	DeepSeek's own API runs in China: use it only with DPO-approved s.29 safeguards, otherwise run DeepSeek through a cloud provider in an approved region
Access	Own record and direct reports only; leaders see groups of 10+; HR access audited
Security	SSO + MFA, encryption, web firewall, OWASP and AI top-10 tests; pen test week 9
Retention	Employment + 1 year; chats 90 days (to confirm with the DPO)

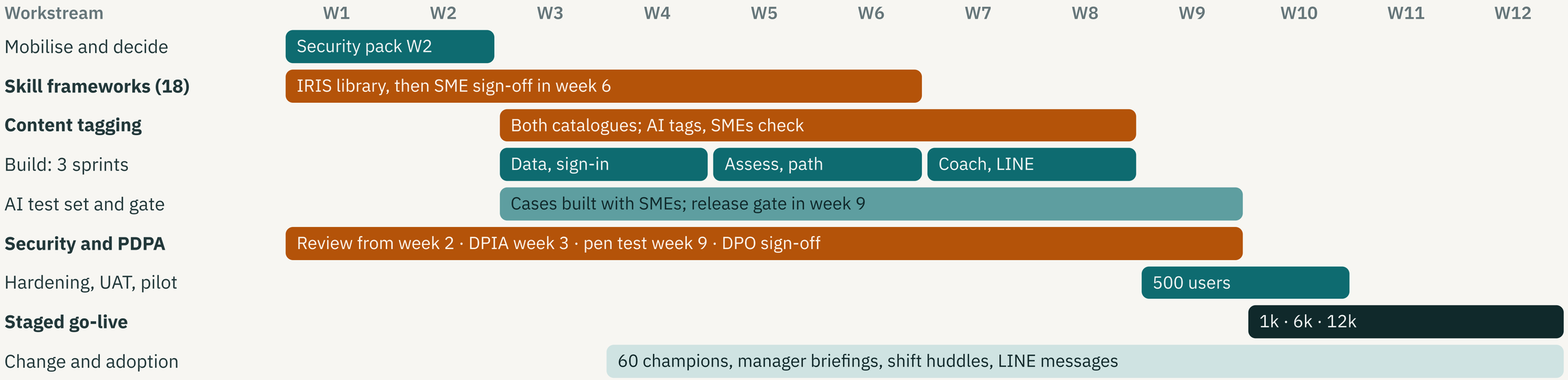
What reaches the AI



SO WHAT Privacy approval is on the critical path, so it starts in week 1 (security pack to IT in week 2), not week 10.

Source: Thai PDPA (s.28/29 cross-border transfers, PDPC DPIA guidance) · production decisions need client counsel and DPO sign-off

12 weeks with a staged go-live from week 10; security, data and frameworks set the critical path



Amber = critical path **Gates:** W2 security pack · W6 frameworks and demo · W9 AI gate + pen test · W10 security/DPO go/no-go · W12 all enabled

16.4 FTE **IRIS team, about 18 people**

Including delivery lead, architect, 4 engineers, AI engineer, 2 data and integration engineers, 2 QA, designer, DevSecOps, skills lead, 2 consultants, content analyst and change lead.

60 champions **plus the client team**

HR product owner, HR system owner, 2 LMS admins, IT security, DPO, 2 SMEs per business unit and 60 champions. A weekly product council keeps the date fixed and lets scope flex.

SO WHAT Going live in stages from week 10 means one bad week still lands before the forum: the forum is the deadline, not the target.

Source: proposed delivery plan · team cost in the IRIS planning model

Four high risks could move the date; each has an owner, a decision week and a fallback agreed in advance

4 high
risks to the date, plus 2 medium; none of them is code

6 owners
each risk has one IRIS and one client owner

5 gates
W2 security pack · W6 frameworks · W9 AI gate · W10 go/no-go · W12 all live

Weekly
product council reviews every risk and approves any fallback

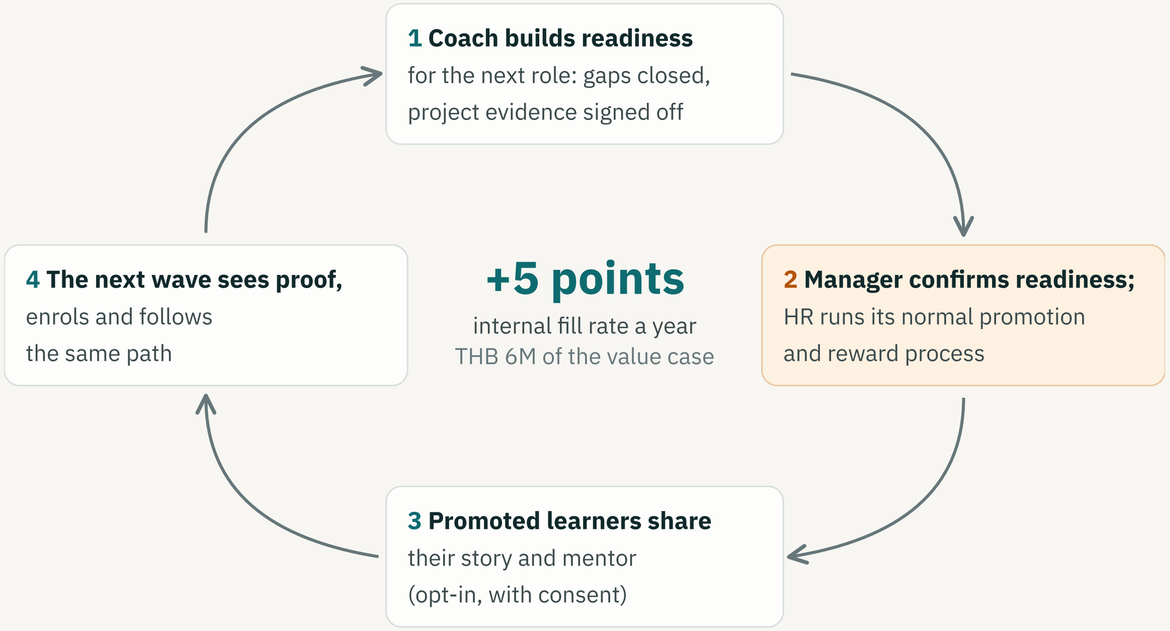
RISK TO THE DATE AND OWNER	LEVEL	DECIDED	HOW WE MANAGE IT	FALLBACK
Security or PDPA approval late Owner: IRIS architect + client IT security and DPO	● **High**	W2 W10	Security pack in week 2; weekly clinic with IT security; reuse their approved cloud patterns	Approved reduced mode; otherwise defer employee-data use
Frameworks not agreed Owner: IRIS skills lead + 2 SMEs per business unit	● **High**	W6	Start from the IRIS library (~70% reuse); SME sign-off by week 6; monthly updates	Current-role frameworks only; next role later
HR and LMS data quality Owner: IRIS data engineer + HR system owner	● **High**	W2 W10	Profile data in weeks 1-2; job-code mapping; a "wrong manager?" button; CSV fallback	Approvals go to the HRBP
Scope creep across 5 BUs Owner: Product council: CHRO delegate + IRIS lead	● **High**	Weekly	Change control; every new request is costed and dated; backlog for later waves	Move it to wave 2
Frontline access and adoption Owner: IRIS change lead + 60 champions	● **Med**	W10-W12	LINE entry; 5-minute check in shift huddles; 2 h a month of paid learning time	Supervisor-led sessions on shared tablets
AI quality in Thai Owner: IRIS AI engineer + native reviewers	● **Med**	W9	Release gate; narrow scope; fixed replies for sensitive topics; weekly SME review	Switch to a stronger model (V4 Pro or Claude Sonnet); coach answers lesson content only

SO WHAT Every risk is decided at a fixed gate with a fallback ready, so a slip shows up by week 10 while two weeks of staged go-live remain.

Source: proposed risk register · gates from the 12-week plan (slide 9)

Scale to 45,000 by making career moves visible: each wave's promotions pull the next wave in

The career flywheel: the coach works until people reach their next role



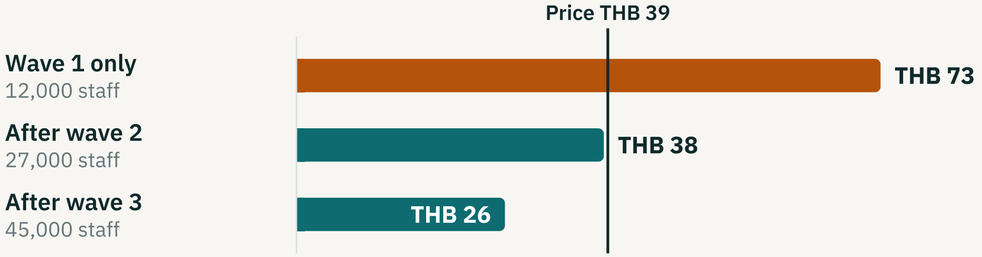
Guardrail: the Suite never decides pay or promotion. It builds readiness and, with consent, makes success visible.

Three waves, one platform

Wave 1 · month 4 **12,000 people**	Retail & Distribution and Packaging, Thailand. Prove the loop, set the baseline, produce the first promotion stories.
Wave 2 · month 7 **+15,000 people**	Building Materials, Corporate Services, rest of Thailand. AI drafts frameworks from job descriptions; SMEs check them; wave-1 mentors join the champions.
Wave 3 · month 13 **+18,000 people**	Chemicals and 3 ASEAN countries: local languages, a DPIA per country, local content.

What scaling costs: content, not code. Fixed rollout fees of THB 6M (wave 2) and THB 9M (wave 3) cover frameworks, translation and local privacy reviews.

Run cost per employee a month falls below the price as waves land



SO WHAT Visible career moves drive adoption: each promoted learner recruits the next wave, and run cost falls from THB 73 to THB 26.

Source: proposed rollout plan · internal-fill value and run cost from the IRIS planning model

THB 17.5M fixed to build and THB 39 per employee a month to run; at scale the value is about 2x the subscription

What it costs IRIS

THB 8.5M

to build in 12 weeks: team 6.7M, third-party 0.8M, contingency (15%) 1.0M

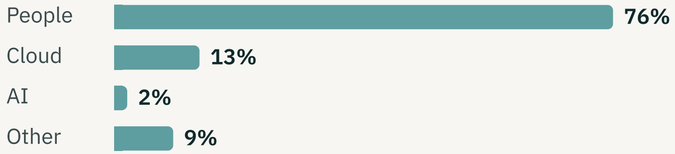
THB 73

run cost per employee a month at 12,000 staff

THB 26

at 45,000 staff (month 36)

Run cost at scale, by type

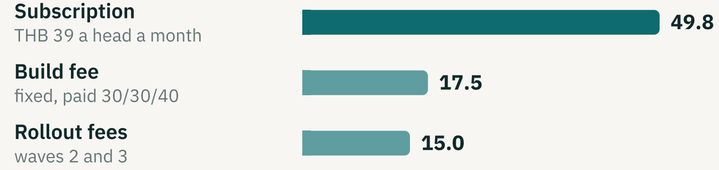


Margin on the build fee: **51.2%**; over 3 years: **35.5%**.

What we propose to charge

1. **THB 17.5M fixed build fee,** including a 10% premium for the fixed date; paid 30 / 30 / 40.
2. **THB 39 per employee per month** for platform, hosting, AI coach and second-line support; minimum 20,000 from wave 2; 3-year term.
3. **Fixed rollout fees:** wave 2 THB 6M; wave 3 THB 9M, including ASEAN localisation.
4. **10% of the subscription at risk** on adoption KPIs; nothing tied to business KPIs until there is a baseline.

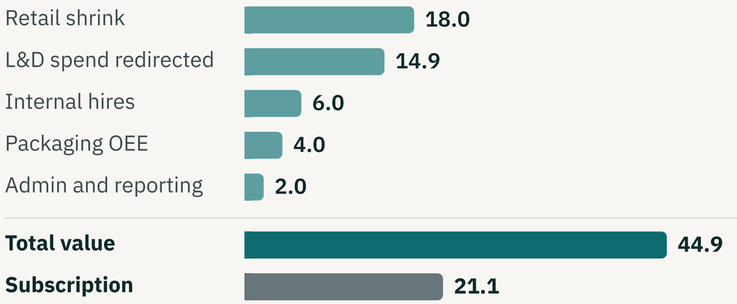
Where the THB 82M comes from (3 years, THB M)



What the client gets back

THB M	Y1	Y2	Y3	TOTAL
Client pays	31.2	30.1	21.1	**82.3**
IRIS profit	10.8	11.5	7.0	**29.2**

THB 45M a year value at scale, THB M



Payback: results lag, so 3-year value (THB 78M) is just under spend (THB 82M); payback comes early in year 4. **Break-even:** a 3.5% cut in shrink alone covers the subscription, which is 14% of today's L&D spend per head.

SO WHAT IRIS carries the date risk and is paid for it; the client pays as it scales, and a 3.5% cut in shrink alone would cover the subscription.

Source: IRIS planning model (1,207 formulas, zero errors, 143 independent checks) · 35.5% gross margin · prices exclude VAT · value to validate with client finance in weeks 1-2